

AUTISM AWARENESS SERIES

Two Kinds of Empathy

Two survival systems, not a deficit

#4 — The Double Empathy Problem

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Autistic people lack empathy.
That's not what's happening.

NEUROTYPICAL EMPATHY

Ambient social threat detection.



Is this person ok?
Am I reading the room?

AUTISTIC EMPATHY

Active information-seeking.



What happened?
What do you need?

Can't read the signals



Can't parse the ambient cues



Both sides struggle.
Neither side is broken.



Different systems.
Same intention: to understand.



Not a deficit.
A different way of caring.

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